

FREE PATTERN

Free Granny Square Blanket Pattern for Beginners

How many squares to make, how to join them, and a clean border — the full blanket built from squares you already know how to make.

Updated 2026 • US terms • Lap-size throw, about 42 x 56in / 107 x 142cm



This pattern builds directly on our [granny square tutorial](#) — if you haven't made a single square yet, start there first. Once you can make one square confidently, the blanket is really three steps: make enough squares, join them, and finish the edge with a border.

MATERIALS

- Worsted-weight yarn, roughly 1,400–1,600 yards total (one colour or several for a multicolour blanket)
- 5.0mm (US size H) crochet hook
- Yarn needle, for joining and weaving in ends
- Scissors
- Optional: blocking mat and pins

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR .	MEANS
ch	Chain
dc	Double crochet
sc	Single crochet
sl st	Slip stitch
sp	Space
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

GAUGE

Each finished square should measure about 6 x 6in / 15 x 15cm after 4 rounds, using a 5.0mm hook and worsted yarn. If your squares run smaller or larger, adjust your hook size before making all 48 — consistency between squares matters more than hitting this exact number.

NOTES

- This pattern makes a lap-size throw from 48 squares in a 6 by 8 grid. For a larger throw, make more squares and adjust the grid — see the FAQ below for sizing guidance.
- Written in US terms, continuing from the 3-round square in our [granny square tutorial](#).
- Block each square before joining if your tension varies between sessions — see our [blocking guide](#) for methods.

Step 1: Make 48 squares

Using the 3-round pattern from our [granny square tutorial](#), make 48 squares total. Work them in one colour throughout, or change colours each round for a classic multicolour granny look — both are structurally identical.

Step 2: Block your squares (optional but recommended)

Lay each square flat, dampen slightly, and pin to a consistent 6 x 6in / 15 x 15cm before letting it dry. This step evens out small tension differences between squares made on different days, and makes joining much easier. Full instructions are in our [blocking guide](#).

Step 3: Arrange your layout

Lay all 48 squares out on the floor in a 6-square by 8-square grid before joining anything. This is the easiest point to fix a colour arrangement you don't like — much harder once squares are sewn together.

Step 4: Join the squares

METHOD: WHIP STITCH

With right sides facing up, thread a yarn needle with a long length of yarn. Working one row at a time, whip stitch through the outer loops of matching stitches along the edge of two squares, from corner to corner. Repeat to join all squares in each row, then join the rows to each other the same way.

Whip stitching is the simplest join for a first blanket. If you want a more finished, textured seam, single crocheting the squares together as you join them is the alternative — both are equally valid, whip stitch is just faster to learn.

Step 5: Border

ROUND 1

Join yarn in any corner space of the joined blanket. Ch 3, work [2 dc, ch 2, 3 dc] in the corner space. Work dc evenly along each edge, working [3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc] in each corner, until you reach the starting point. Sl st to join.

ROUND 2

Sc evenly around the entire border, working 3 sc in each corner ch-2 space to keep the corners flat. Sl st to join.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all remaining ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

How many granny squares do I need for a throw blanket?

A lap-sized throw made from 6-inch squares typically needs a 6 by 8 grid, or 48 squares. A larger throw blanket uses closer to 63 squares in a 7 by 9 grid.

What is the best way to join granny squares for a beginner?

Whip stitching the squares together with a yarn needle is the simplest method for a first blanket, since it doesn't require an extra crochet step and is forgiving of small tension differences between squares.

Do all my granny squares need to be exactly the same size?

They should be close, within about a quarter inch of each other. Blocking each square flat before joining helps even out small size differences caused by natural tension variation between crocheting sessions.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest,

beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.